Structured leadership succession plan developed for Linux

A formal, open source succession and continuity plan has been adopted to safeguard the future of the world's most critical open source infrastructure based on Linux, ensuring development continues smoothly if Linus Torvalds steps aside.

The move addresses a long-standing governance risk. Torvalds has served as the ultimate judge and executor of all commits to the Canonical Linux repository for more than 30 years, retaining final authority over the codebase that underpins countless hardware and software products worldwide.

Drafted by Dan Williams and co-signed by Torvalds, the document defines "a plan for navigating events that affect the forward progress of the Canonical Linux repository, torvalds/linux.git." If Torvalds becomes unwilling or unable to continue, successors must step in "without delay."

The process is structured and time-bound. The last Maintainer Summit Organizer initiates discussions, with the Linux Foundation Technical Advisory Board acting as backup. A successor discussion must begin within 72 hours, followed by a meeting of summit invitees, TAB members and additional maintainers. The chosen canonical maintainer is announced within two weeks.

Although Linux has more than 100 maintainers, decision-making has remained centralised with Torvalds. The new plan distributes responsibility and formalises leadership transfer.

Linus Torvalds

Open source preference remains weak, with only 4% choosing open weights and 2% selecting Meta's Llama.

Meanwhile, 62% plan to adopt AI-agentic workflows, despite warnings that "Agentic workflows are also the most expensive and failure-prone pattern," with cost already the top barrier.

Structural gaps persist. 16% cite lack of sovereign datasets, while experts argue India needs multilingual local data more than GPUs. Talent shortages are operational rather than technical: "The talent bottleneck isn't in ML engineering. It's in AI ops."

Western platforms dominate across the stack, with OpenAI and Anthropic leading text and code tools, underscoring a clear reality: India is consuming AI infrastructure, not building it.

Claude goes open source and Indian IT stocks slide

Anthropic has released 11 open source plugins for its Claude Cowork platform, making enterprise AI automation freely accessible to developers and businesses and allowing companies to integrate, customise, and deploy workflows without proprietary lock-in.

The move immediately rattled markets in India, where IT services depend heavily on large teams and billable hours. Indian IT export shares slumped about 6.3 per cent overall, with the NSE/Nifty IT index heading for its worst session since March 2020. Blue-chip stocks bore the brunt of the sell-off.

Investor concerns centre on the plug-ins' ability to automate tasks across legal, sales, marketing, analytics, coding, testing, and documentation — work traditionally handled by large offshore teams.

"As Indian enterprises integrate Claude for critical coding workflows, dependency on large vendor teams may decline, squeezing billable hours and margins. Anthropic's advanced AI systems also threaten entry-level talent pool at Indian IT firms by replacing routine development and testing tasks," said Ambrish Shah, analyst, Systematix Group.

Toyota introduces Fluorite, an open source game engine for vehicle dashboards

Toyota Connected North America has unveiled Fluorite, an open source game engine designed to deliver console-grade interactive experiences for in-vehicle digital cockpits and dashboards, signalling a clear shift towards open technologies for its next-generation vehicle user experience stack.

Developed by Toyota Connected North America in Plano, Texas, the engine was introduced at FOSDEM 2026 in Brussels, a community-driven conference dedicated to open source software. While initially targeted at automotive displays, the platform could eventually extend to consoles such as Xbox or PlayStation.

Fluorite is built entirely on open source foundations, combining Google's Flutter UI toolkit, the Dart programming language, and Google's Filament 3D rendering engine. It runs on an embedded stack already proven inside Toyota vehicles, including Flutter runtime, Yocto Linux, and Wayland, and supports deployment across Android, iOS/macOS, Windows, Linux, and WebGL.

Positioned as the first console-grade engine fully integrated with Flutter, Fluorite delivers hardware-accelerated graphics via Vulkan, alongside physically based rendering, accurate lighting, post-processing effects, custom shaders, and multiple simultaneous 3D scene views.